R FOR DATA ANALYSIS · WORKING WITH DATA · LESSON 2

02 Remove columns and rows

Drop columns with a minus sign in select(), and drop rows by their number.

BY THE END OF THIS SECTION YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Remove one or two columns with select(-)
- Remove a row with [-135,]
- Remove several rows with c()

The R code in this lesson

```
# Remove one column
demographic <- demographic %>% select(-`0.2 District Name`)

# Remove two columns
demographic <- demographic %>% select(-`0.2 District Name`, -`0.11 Sex of household
head`)

# Remove one row (row 135)
demographic <- demographic[-135, ]

# Remove several rows
demographic <- demographic[-c(131, 132, 133, 134), ]
```

What you will hear (times count from the end of the intro)

Intro Sometimes the easiest way to clean data is to take things away. In this lesson, you will learn to remove columns with a simple minus sign, and to remove rows by their number, one or several at a time. Let's tidy up our table.

0:00 Our demographic table has five columns. Under the note, to remove a column from a data frame, we use select again, but with a minus sign before the column name.

0:22 Demographic, pipe, select, minus, district name. The minus means: everything except this column.

0:43 Run it. In the Environment, demographic now has four variables. The district column is gone.

1:04 Next, I remove the sex of household head column the same way. Now we have three variables.

1:25 To remove two columns at once, put both inside select, each with a minus sign, separated by a comma. First, I recreate the full table, so we can try it again.

1:50 Now rows. Rows are removed with square brackets. Demographic, open bracket, minus one hundred thirty five, comma, close bracket. The number before the comma is the row. Nothing after the comma means: keep all columns.

2:05 Before running it, let's look at the table. The last row is number one hundred thirty five.

2:20 Run it, and the Environment shows one hundred thirty four observations. Row one hundred thirty five is gone.

2:45 For several rows, use c inside the brackets: minus c, one hundred thirty one, one hundred thirty two, and so on. Be careful to close every bracket.

3:05 Minus means remove. For columns, inside select. For rows, inside square brackets. You've got this!